



By adding tone, voice and visual cues to the mix, video helps employees grasp the idea that the individual on the other side of the screen intends to relay

mix, it helps employees understand what the individual on the other side of the screen intends to convey.

Brian A Victoria, of the University of Auckland, says, "Studies have shown that people remember 20 per cent of what they hear, 40 per cent of what they see and hear, but 70 per cent of what they see, hear, and do." Video conferencing helps reduce the cost of travel, accommodation and the time taken to travel. It's also an ideal way of interviewing candidates living in far-off places.

Video Web conference can boost a business environment. Corporations now leverage previous investments in intranets, extranets and the Internet to create Web casts, which are significantly cheaper than any previous form of video production. These events use video streaming, either on demand or an archived or on-demand basis—participants no longer have to participate in real-time. These video events enable management to consistently put forth their vision, or update employees about projects. Communication, being visual, is faster and can be done on a regular basis. This can be extrapolated to include video content in events, impromptu meetings and also to train staff in informal sessions.

Convergence has ushered even more devices into the scenario—mobile phones are one such example. In Europe, testing is underway to check the viability of promoting TV shopping channel access on mobile phones. Mobile technologies have taken large strides ahead and almost every mobile device is equipped with a camera. Hence, it's not hard to picture a scenario wherein video conferences will be held with participants on the move, around the world.

Video in India

Web conferencing The concept of Web conferencing is rapidly being adopted. Indian corporates, including bigwigs such as Johnson & Johnson, Infosys Technologies, MindTree and Polaris, are realising the cost-effectiveness and benefits of Web conferencing. According to Business Communications Review magazine, globally, 11 million individuals representing 13,000 customer organisations, either regularly or occasionally, used Web conferencing in 2001. This number is expected to rise to 79 million individuals and 94,000 organisations by 2005.

Streaming video Streaming video is also slowly gaining acceptance around the world, as

Honda and Saab-Interactive Video

These companies perceived a gap in the traditional use of video advertising—while it showed images of the company, it did not permit the viewer to interact with it. They have since begun using a format that has been termed as companion interactivity. While the video advertisement is running, they provide data collection information as a response to consumer inputs, and even direct consumers to navigate to a particular page or site.

PROS

Instant gratification; possibly instant sales

CONS

Deviates from advertising mantra of keeping user glued to a particular site rather than navigating away from it.

a cheap way to disseminate information. According to Jon Klein, former Executive Vice-President of New York-based CBS News, "Bandwidth costs alone have dropped so much that it's often cheaper to post a video online, than duplicate and 'FedEx' it to viewers."

Improvements in the ability of content delivery networks to deliver a stream of video without interruption, has resulted in almost broadcast-quality video to the desktop. Streaming video also provides more information on who's watching what on a Web site, and enables better targeting by companies.

Intracompany event promotion Companies often use video to promote knowledge dissemination within their staff. For example, TiE, The Indus Entrepreneurs, needed to promote its annual retreat in Goa in 2003. The product was aimed for staff and potential partners, and was promotional in nature.

Although created for a one-time event, the video forms an important record of company events, and can be used repeatedly to acquaint new recruits to company culture, and provide a basis to plan future events.

Training This is one of the most popular uses of video. Companies such as JC Penny, an online shopping and advertising organisation, create videos on a regular basis for staff on topics that range from managing your pension plan to understanding new distribution and procurement procedures. Other companies use video to provide training on conflict resolution and sexual harassment. Video is especially helpful to train staff employed in different locations. It can also substitute experienced staff to conduct training sessions.

To better understand the uses of video, let's answer a few basic questions:

Why video and not print products?

Today, most companies have a hybrid video-print model in place. Combinations of print and video products are packaged as marketing materials, and complement each other. Similarly, video—especially Web-based video—often contains references to print publications and Web sites. Even major newspapers continue with paper circula-

? What can Video do for me?

- ❑ Promote the company by including a corporate image video (video cassette or CD-ROM) in sales materials and presentations.
- ❑ Train employees, and explain the standard procedures and responsibilities involved with different positions.
- ❑ Provide a quick reference to product portfolios for customers.
- ❑ Ensure continuous attention at large events such as trade shows and exhibits.
- ❑ Record one-off events, such as a seminar or presentation, for replay.
- ❑ Produce creative spots that maximise your advertising spends.
- ❑ Encourage team building, by providing visibility for staff by putting up office or personal photos in an attractive format with special effects and music.